Special Needs Co-Parenting Assessment Report™

A child-focused reflection built from your responses across a 10-principle special-needs framework

Thank you for completing the SA CoParents™ Special Needs Co-Parenting Assessment.

This report reflects **your** responses about how your family supports a child with developmental, medical, therapeutic, educational, or behavioral differences. It highlights your strengths, identifies where you can grow, and gives you practical strategies to try — whether or not the other parent participates yet. It is not a psychological evaluation, medical diagnosis, or legal opinion. It is a preparation tool to help you keep your child's needs at the center of every decision.

OVERALL CO-PARENTING READINESS

Building Progress

Your responses show a clear commitment to your child's unique needs. Your strongest areas are **Understanding & Sharing your child's diagnosis** and **Practicing compassion and patience**. Your priority focus area is **Open, child-focused communication with the other parent** — where the SA CoParents™ Communication Toolkit later in this report is specifically recommended for you. Because your child has additional support needs, the **Child Impact Predictor** also appears in this report.

Assessment Findings by Principle

The special-needs framework is built around ten evidence-based co-parenting principles. Each is summarized below with your rating and a one-line finding based on your responses.

PRINCIPLE 1
Build an Individualized Parenting Plan
Fair

Your schedule reflects some of your child's transition tolerance and sensory needs, but the plan isn't yet treated as a living document that adapts as she grows.

PRINCIPLE 2
Prioritize Consistent Routines & Predictability
Good

Meals, bedtime, therapy, and transitions are predictable in your home. Cross-home alignment on core routines still varies and drives most exchange-day anxiety.

PRINCIPLE 3
Maintain Open, Child-Focused Communication
Needs Improvement

Therapy updates, medication changes, IEP notes, and behavioral incidents are shared inconsistently. No shared calendar, log, or app is in use today. **Priority focus.**

PRINCIPLE 4
Align on Core Expectations
Fair

Parenting styles differ, but medication schedules and therapy participation are largely aligned. Screen-time limits and behavior expectations differ meaningfully between homes.

PRINCIPLE 5
Understand & Share Your Child's Diagnosis and Needs
Excellent

You clearly understand your child's diagnosis, sensory profile, and support needs. You actively seek information and share it with providers — a genuine strength.

PRINCIPLE 6
Coordinate Education & Therapy
Good

You attend ARD/IEP meetings, reinforce therapy homework, and use visual supports at home. Sharing IEP updates and 504 changes with the other parent would close the last gap.

PRINCIPLE 7
Manage Transitions Smoothly
Fair

You use transition warnings and comfort items at home. Exchange locations aren't always sensory-friendly, and supports don't reliably travel to the other home.

PRINCIPLE 8
Be Flexible and Adaptable
Good

You adjust routines as your child's needs evolve and revisit the plan after major changes (new school year, medication adjustments, growth phases).

PRINCIPLE 9
Build a Support Network
Good

Therapists, teachers, and case managers are actively engaged. A special-needs family attorney and a peer support group would round out the network.

PRINCIPLE 10
Practice Compassion and Patience
Excellent

You consistently approach disagreements with empathy, model self-regulation for your child, and focus on solutions rather than blame — a durable co-parenting strength.

Your Strengths

- ✓ You clearly understand your child's diagnosis, strengths, and support needs.
- ✓ Your home offers predictable routines, sensory supports, and a calm regulation environment.
- ✓ You consistently reinforce therapy homework and skill practice at home.
- ✓ You attend medical, therapy, and IEP/ARD meetings and stay informed.
- ✓ You encourage your child's participation in adaptive activities and celebrate her progress.
- ✓ You are actively seeking a lower-conflict path so your child can regulate more easily.

Practical Focus Areas

Where your day-to-day support of a child with additional needs actually happens. Each subsection has a rating and specific next actions.

Pick-Up & Drop-Off (Sensory-Aware Transitions)

Needs Improvement

Your child shows anxiety before exchanges. Regulation drops after transitions, especially when supports don't travel with her.

- → Consider a **neutral, low-stimulation exchange location** — school parking lot, familiar quiet park, or library entrance — instead of the front door.
- → Use a **visual schedule / transition countdown** at both homes 24 hours before each exchange.
- → Ensure comfort items (weighted blanket, headphones, favorite toy) **always travel** with your child.
- → Establish a scripted, predictable hand-off routine your child can rely on.
- → If safety is ever a concern, most cities offer designated **"safe exchange" locations** at police stations.

Meeting Your Child's Educational Needs (IEP / 504)

Fair

You attend ARD/IEP meetings and reinforce accommodations at home. The other parent isn't reliably included in IEP updates, 504 changes, or classroom behavior plans.

- → Add **both parents** to the school's parent portal, teacher email lists, and special-education case-manager updates.
- → Attend IEP/ARD/504 meetings **together** when possible; if not, send a written summary within 48 hours.
- → Align classroom accommodations (visual supports, sensory breaks, extended time) with home routines.
- → Share progress-monitoring data, behavior plans, and executive-function goals in one central document.
- → Coordinate on tutoring, therapy pull-outs, and adaptive extracurricular sign-ups.

Medical, Therapy & Skill Reinforcement

Good

You coordinate specialists, therapy appointments, and medications well. Therapy carryover at the other parent's home is inconsistent, which slows progress.

- → Maintain one **shared medical & therapy calendar** (AppClose, OFW, or a shared Google Calendar).
- → Attend annual well-checks, specialist evaluations, and IEP-related medical letters together when possible.
- → Share a **one-page therapy homework sheet** from OT, speech, and behavioral providers so both homes reinforce the same skills.
- → Use identical medication routines — same time, same dose, same tracker — in both homes.
- → Agree on an **emergency contact protocol**: who to call first, in what order, and how quickly.

More Practical Focus Areas

Special Events at School

Fair

You attend most classroom performances and awards, but sensory-heavy events (Field Day, holiday parties) can overwhelm your child without coordinated supports.

- → Share the **school-year calendar** with the other parent each semester — conferences, IEP meetings, performances, field trips.
- → Before large or sensory-heavy events, coordinate **sensory supports** (headphones, quiet area, exit plan) with the teacher **and** the other parent.
- → Confirm with your child which parent will attend so she isn't caught in scheduling ambiguity.
- → Attend IEP/ARD/504 progress-review meetings **together** when possible.
- → Celebrate promotions, awards, and small wins in **both** homes.

Extracurricular & Adaptive Activities

Fair

Your child does adaptive swimming and a social-skills group. Attendance during your time is consistent; you're less certain about the other parent's time.

- → Share the **season/term activity schedule** with the other parent as early as possible.
- → Coordinate transportation and equipment hand-offs; make sure sensory supports, communication devices, and comfort items travel with her.
- → Support the same activity during **both** parenting times — inconsistent attendance erodes skill progress and social confidence.
- → Give coaches, instructors, and social-skills leaders a **single point of contact** and share her strengths and support needs proactively.
- → Consider therapy-based activities (therapeutic riding, adaptive recreation, sensory play groups) that reinforce OT/speech goals.

SA COPARENTS™ COMMUNICATION TOOLKIT

Because communication is your priority focus area

Two evidence-based tools are recommended when co-parent communication is flagged as **Needs Improvement**. Both are widely used in family courts, by mediators, and by special-education case managers.

B
Brief
Keep messages to 3–4 sentences. Long replies invite escalation.

I
Informative
Facts only — therapy times, medication doses, IEP updates. No interpretation.

F
Friendly
Polite tone, no sarcasm. Assume it will be read in court.

F
Firm
Clear about what you need. Close the loop; don't invite further debate.

AppClose

FREE · IOS & ANDROID

Shared calendar, secure messaging, expense tracking, and swap requests. Message history is court-admissible. A strong first step when cost is a barrier.

OurFamilyWizard (OFW)

SUBSCRIPTION · COURT-MANDATED IN MANY STATES

Calendar, messaging with **ToneMeter™** that flags emotional language before you send, expense ledger, and journal. Widely accepted by family courts as an evidentiary record.

SA COPARENTS™ DISTINGUISHING FEATURE

Child Impact Predictor

Rather than identifying areas of disagreement alone, the Child Impact Predictor estimates how differences between households may affect your child in practical, day-to-day areas — especially important when your child has additional support needs. This shifts the focus away from blaming the other parent and toward understanding how specific co-parenting patterns influence your child's regulation, therapy progress, and school success.

Routines | School performance | Therapy participation | Emotional regulation | Transitions between homes | Sensory regulation

Personalized Recommendations

- → Adopt the BIFF method for every co-parenting message this month.
- → Choose one shared calendar/messaging app (AppClose or OFW).
- → Build a written IEP/504 summary and share within 48 hours of every update.
- → Create a one-page "how my child regulates" sheet for both homes and providers.
- → Ensure sensory supports and comfort items always travel with your child.
- → Book a child-focused mediation session with a mediator experienced in special-needs cases.
- → Add both parents to therapy carryover updates from OT, speech, and behavioral providers.
- → Consult a special-needs family attorney if any issue remains unresolved after 60 days.

Child Needs Foundation Statement

FOUNDATION STATEMENT

My commitment to my child

"My child benefits from predictable routines, coordinated medical and therapeutic care, consistent educational support, and calm communication with the other parent. I recognize that although the other parent and I may see things differently, my responsibility is to provide stability, reduce unnecessary conflict, and support my child's developmental, emotional, and educational needs. I commit to making decisions that prioritize my child's well-being and to seeking professional guidance whenever needed."

See also: *SA CoParents Co-Parenting Options* — a 2-page reference of ten communication and decision-making approaches. Available at **sacoparentsapp.online/coparenting-options**.

IMPORTANT REMINDER

Every child develops differently. This report is educational and informational only. It is not a psychological evaluation, medical diagnosis, therapy, or legal advice. If you have concerns regarding your child's development, learning, behavior, or safety, consult the appropriate healthcare provider, educational professional, therapist, or attorney. If you are in crisis, call 911 or the National Domestic Violence Hotline at 1-800-799-7233.

Every positive step you take toward cooperation strengthens your child's foundation for success.